

and the tactics that he brings to the table are incredible.

This game is about tactics. I always think we overcomplicate it as bowlers by trying to bowl too many [types of] deliveries in one over. Some of the best bowlers in the world, Glenn McGrath and Brett Lee, for instance, are the masters of a couple of deliveries, and they have chosen them very well.

That's where *Bondi* (Bond) comes into it very, very nicely. He does research on the players and has a good ability to bond with all the



I'VE MOVED AWAY FROM POTENTIAL CRICKET AND MY CAREER AS SUCH WITH THE NEW ZEALAND CRICKET TEAM, BUT I STILL DEFINITELY HAVE AMBITIONS TO REPRESENT MY COUNTRY



bowlers he works with. I think that is important when it comes to moving around franchises and dealing with different squads and personalities every year. It's no wonder why he's been so successful in the IPL for 10-plus years.

Now that you are a freelancer, how do you manage your workload and ensure that you make yourself available for the leagues and also for New Zealand?

There are no shortcuts. I enjoy hitting the gym. I enjoy marking out the cones and doing the running, and I love bowling, so that's why it has never been so much of a chore for me. You have to move with the times.

You can't be complacent and just come to the table with the same plan every time. I spent a lot of time with DJ [Dwayne] Bravo over the last couple of years, and I think he's an inspiration for taking his game to the next level.

He has adapted to his game



Freelancer: Trent Boult was released from his central contract in 2022 to spend more time with his family and to play in franchise leagues around the world.

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around the world, and played 600 T20s for that reason; he still has it. So, for me, it's about taking the lessons from the likes of those guys and just trying to be better every game.

Despite being favourites in ICC white-ball events, New Zealand is yet to win a title. With the T20 World Cup on the horizon, what are your expectations?

I have always thought we have a successful record in ICC events, and that comes down to the fact that it turns out to be very simple equations, like winning a game to reach the semifinals or the final. And, in those situations, I think New

Zealand plays its best cricket, with a very well-planned side that's equipped with some of the best players in the world who can definitely take on any team.

We are not looking too far ahead in the T20 World Cup. The tournament is quite long, consisting of 20 teams, including some lesser-known nations that have yet to show their full potential.

However, there are also some quality teams participating. Therefore, it will require a lot of hard work to succeed, especially during the must-win games. Nevertheless, I'm confident that New Zealand can compete with any team in the world.